Sylhet Division

Bangladesh Studies

Sylhet Division

Sylhet is known as “the land of two leaves and a bud.” Its lush tea gardens, picturesque landscapes, vibrant Khasia and Manipuri communities, stunning orange groves, thriving pineapple plantations, dense tropical forests, and diverse flora and fauna create a mesmerizing experience. Rich in natural resources, Sylhet boasts significant reserves of natural gas and limestone, making it a hub for the tea, cement, and paper industries. Sylhet tea is renowned worldwide, and the Tea Research Institute is located in Srimangal. Other fascinating destinations include Maulvi Bazar, Chhatak, Jaflong, and Fenchuganj. Sylhet is also known as the land of the revered Muslim saint Hazrat Shah Jalal (RA), who played a vital role in spreading Islam in the region. The area is home to the colorful Manipuri, Khasia, and Garo tribes, with Manipuri tribal maidens gaining global recognition for their captivating dance. Additionally, Sylhet is celebrated for its exquisite handcrafted products made from cane and bamboo, showcasing the region's rich artistic heritage.

Sylhet Division

- Sylhet Division is the northeastern division of Bangladesh on the Surma River. It is known for its Sufi shrines.

Geographical Location

- The area of the Sylhet division is 12635.24 sq km. It is bounded by Meghalaya state of India on the north, Tripura state of India on the south, Assam state of India on the east, and Netrokona and Kishoreganj districts on the west.
- Sylhet district area is about 3490.40 sq. km. Sylhet is located on the banks of the Surma.

Administrative Structure

- **The Sylhet Division is divided into four districts:**
  - **Habiganj,**
  - **Moulvibazar,**
  - **Sunamganj and**
  - **Sylhe**

and further divided into 35 upazilas (sub-districts). These upazilas are further divided into 323 union parishads. Each union is roughly divided into 9 wards before going to village-level.

The Division hosts 19 Municipal corporations known as pourashavas, and one city corporation in Sylhet city.

Administrative Structure

Name of District	Area (sq km)	Upazila	Municipality	Ward	Mahalla	Union	Mouza	Village	Population
Maulvibazar 58	2799.38	7	5	45	151	67	917	2015	1919062
Habiganj 36	2574.7	8	5	54	188	75	1127	2120	2023603
Sylhet 91	3217.28	12	5	36	111	94	1450	2915	3232834
Sunamganj 90	3526.12	11	4	36	139	83	1502	2738	2375223

Source Bangladesh Population Census 2001 and 2011,
Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics.

Administrative Structure

1. Parliamentary Constituencies: Total 19 (Sylhet: 06; Sunamganj: 05; Moulvibazar: 04; Habiganj: 04)
2. Upazila: Total 41 (Sylhet: 13; Sunamganj: 12; Moulvibazar: 07; Habiganj: 09)
3. Border Upazila: Total 19 (Sylhet: 06; Sunamganj: 06; Moulvibazar: 05; Habiganj: 02)
4. Police Stations: Total 44 (Sylhet: 17; Sunamganj: 11; Moulvibazar: 07; Habiganj: 09)

https://www.sylhetdiv.gov.bd/en/site/page/a8xo-%E0%A6%8F%E0%A6%95-

Districts and Upazillas

District	Upazilla
Habiganj	Azmiriganj
	Bahubal
	Baniachong
	Chunarughat
	Habiganj-S
	Lakhai
	Madhabpur
	Nabiganj
	Sayestagan

District	Upazilla
Sylhet	Beanibazar
	Biswanath
	Companiganj
	Dakshin
	Surma
	Fenchuganj
	Golapganj
	Gowainghat
	Jointiapur
	Kanaighat
	Osmaninagar
	Sylhet-S
	Zakigan

District	Upazilla
Sunamganj	Biswamvarpur
	Chatak
	Dakhin Sunamganj
	Derai
	Dharmapasha
	Doarabazar
	Jagannathpur
	Jamalganj
	Sulla
	Sunamganj-S
	Tahirpur

District	Upazilla
Moulvibazar	Barlekha
	Juri
	Kamalganj
	Kulaura
	Moulvibazar-S
	Rajnagar
	Sreemangal

Nomenclature

- There are various theories about the origin of the name Sylhet. King 'Guhak' of ancient Gaur state established a hat named after his daughter Shiladevi. Because of this, many people think that the name Silat or Sylhet can be known from 'Shilahat'.
- Also, according to Hindu mythology, the bones of Goddess Sati fell at 51 places in the subcontinent. Two bones of Sati also fell in Sylhet. Another name for Sati is 'Sri'; Hence the name Srihatta can be derived from 'Sri + Hadd'.
- Many people also believe that the name 'Silhat' originates from the 'Sil Hot Jah' command by Hazrat Shahjalal (RA).
- In 640 AD, the Chinese Buddhist scholar and traveler Hiuen Tsang mentioned Sylhet as Shi-Li-Cha-T-L.
- Sylhet is mentioned as 'Silahet' in the book 'Kitabul Hind' by the Muslim traveler Manishi Al Beruni in the 11th century AD.
- The name Sylhet is Anglicized from the Bengali word Srihatta. In Indo-Aryan languages Sri means prestige or beauty and Hatta is a term for human settlement. According to Mughal Empire's records Srihatta was used to define the district in Bengal Subah (an administrative unit back then). The term changed to Sylhet in English during British Indian era.
- Although it was first mentioned as 'Silhet' in documents during the English period, after Cachar came under British rule in the early 19th century, it was referred to as 'Sylhet' to distinguish it from 'Silchar', the headquarters station of the district. This is how today's Sylhet name was born.
- In the official documents and historical papers, Sylhet was often referred to as Jalalabad during the era of the Muslim rule.

History









- It was ruled by the Buddhist and Hindu kingdoms of Harikela and Kamarupa before the early medieval period.
- In the early medieval period, It was controlled by the Sena and Deva dynasties.
- The 14th century marked the beginning of Islamic influence in Sylhet. During the medieval period, Sylhet was a leading centre of Persian-speaking Muslim missionaries
- Sylhet was part of British India and was administered as part of the Assam Province.
- In the late 18th century, the British East India Company became interested in Sylhet and saw it as an area of strategic importance in the war against Burma.
- From 1947 to 1971, Sylhet was part of East Pakistan after the partition of India and the creation of Pakistan. Initially, it was part of the East Bengal province, but in 1955, it became part of the East Pakistan province.
- Following the Bangladesh Liberation War, Sylhet became part of independent Bangladesh in 1971.
- The four districts remained in the Chittagong Division until 1995, when they formed the new Sylhet Division. From 1995 to now, Sylhet remains part of the Sylhet Division, one of Bangladesh’s eight administrative divisions.

Sylhet District

- **Sylhet District located in north-east Bangladesh, is one of the four districts in Sylhet Division, which contains Sylhet, the regional capital.**
- **Sylhet is an ancient hometown of 360 Awalias, with the great saint Hazrat Shahjalal (ra) and Hazrat Shah Paran (R).**
- **Historians believe that Sylhet or Srihatta was known to be a remarkable trade center before long.**
- **In 14th century, Hazrat Shahjalal (R) conquered Sylhet and started preaching Islam.**

Sylhet District

- The famous Muslim traveler, Al-Burmani, named him Sylhet in his book 'Kitabul Hind'. It was known from many ancient times that this district was known as 'Sreehatta', according to Hindu mythology, 'Sree' means 'suffix' or 'beauty' and meaning 'hand'. Where Sri Hansen was found, it is Shreehastha, which has been named as Shreehatta in the evolution of time. This area is called Sylhet due to the abundance of stone, which is called Shilah and due to the abundance of stone. Sylhet word sequence means seal and prefix heats means that market is market. Since ancient times, the district stone (shil) and hats (business and commerce) were prevalent, so many people think that the word 'shil' and 'hat' together with the word 'Sylhet' has originated.
- Sylhet district was established on 17 March 1772. Until 1874, this district was affiliated with the Dhaka Division. In that year, Sylhet was included in the indigenous Assam province. During the partition of the country in 1947, Sylhet district was transferred to East Pakistan after the referendum. Sylhet district was then under the Chittagong division. In 1983-84, the Greater Sylhet district was divided into 4 new districts, and on 1 August 1995, Sylhet division was formed.

City Corporation



- Sylhet Division was formed on 1 August 1995. Sylhet Municipality was formed in 1867 and was upgraded to a City Corporation with 27 wards on 9 April 2001.
- Sylhet City Corporation (in short: SCC), is a local governing body that manages all civic services in the Sylhet, a city of Bangladesh. It follows The City Corporation act, 2009 and derives most of its powers from.

Demography

- **Population Total 95,50,722;**
- **Male 4754567, female 4796155; Muslim 8167788,**
- **Hindu 1348180,**
- **Buddhist 1188,**
- **Christian 21931 and others 11635**

- **Source: Banglapedia**

Demography

- **Total Population: 1,10,34,863**
- **Village Population : 89,63,639 (81.23%)**
- **Urban Population : 20,65,123 (18.77%)**
- **Population density: 873 people per square kilometer.**
- **Minorities: Manipuri, Khasia, Garo, Patra, Lusai, Hajong, Sawtal, Tripura, Tipra**
- **Minority Population: 1,36,594 people**

https://www.sylhetdiv.gov.bd/en/site/page/a8xo-

Educational Institutions

- A lot of educational institutions are running under Sylhet division.
- Out of the huge number of educational institutions they have top listed institutions. Which are top ranked not only in Bangladesh but also in South Asia.



https://www.sylhetdiv.gov.bd/en/site/page/a8xo-

Notable Educational Institutions

- Murali chad college
- Shahjalal University of Science and Technology
- Sylhet Agricultural University
- Sylhet MAG Osmani Medical College
- Sylhet Engineering College (SEC)
- North East University Bangladesh
- Metropolitan University

Educational Institutions

- **Some old educational institutions in Sylhet:**
- **1) Murali chad college**
- **2) Government Jubilee High School**
- **3) Sylhet Government Women’s College**

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST)

- Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST) is a public research university based in Sylhet, Bangladesh. Established in 1986, the Shahjalal University of Science and Technology is a non-profit public higher education institution located in the urban setting of the large city of Sylhet. Officially recognized by the University Grants Commission of Bangladesh, Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST) is a large-sized coeducational Bangladeshi higher education institution. Located in Kumargaon, Sylhet, SUST is renowned for its focus on science and technology education.



- Shahjalal University of Science & Technology (SUST) is also situated in Sylhet which is the top ranked public university in Bangladesh.
- It is the 8th oldest university of the country and the first university to adopt American credit system.
- The university is known for its pioneering research and education in the physical sciences and engineering.
- In 2016, SUST ranked as the top research university in Bangladesh (610th in the world) by Scopus-SCImago institution ranking.
- In 2017, the university had highest research expenditure among all universities in Bangladesh





Sylhet Agricultural University

Sylhet Agricultural University (SAU) was established in 2006 to promote agricultural education and research. The university is located in the heart of Sylhet and offers a range of programs focused on agricultural sciences.



Sylhet MAG Osmani Medical College

The Sylhet MAG Osmani Medical College (SOMC) is a government medical school in Bangladesh, established in 1962. It is located in Sylhet. Originally named "Sylhet Medical College", it was renamed in 1986 in the honour of General Muhammad Ataul Gani Osmani, commander-in-chief of Bangladesh Forces during the Bangladesh War of Independence of 1971. The college is affiliated with Sylhet Medical University.



Madan Mohan College

Madan Mohan College is a public college in Sylhet, Bangladesh. It was established in 1940. Many notable people have completed their intermediate education from this college. Madan Mohan College was established by Mohini Mohan Das, Jugendra Mohan Das and Prafulla Mohan Das in memory of their father Madan Mohan Das on 26 January 1940. Its founder principal was Pramod Chandra Goswamee.



In Sylhet there are so many universities without SUST. They are:

- Sylhet Agricultural University
- Sylhet Engineering College
- Leading University
- Metropolitan University, Sylhet
- North East University
- Sylhet International University

In Sylhet, there are some British curriculum-based Schools. They are

- Banyan British School
- Cambridge Grammar School & College
- Oxford International School & College Sylhet
- Presidency School & College
- Royal Institute of Smart Education
- Sylhet Grammar School

IMPORTANT PLACES IN SYLHET

IMPORTANT PLACES TO VISIT IN SYLHET



Sreemangal

- **Sreemangal** is an upazila of **Moulvibazar District** in the Sylhet Division of Bangladesh. Sreemangal has been named the tea capital of Bangladesh due to the number of tea gardens in the area and is the place of origin of the Seven ColorTea.
- The Bangladesh Tea Research Institute in Sreemangal has made a number of contributions in evolving and standardising the quality of tea, and introducing its research findings to tea industry of Bangladesh. Pineapples from the Sreemangal area are known for their flavour and natural sweetness.



- **Jaflong (the daughter of nature)** is a hill station and tourist destination in the Division of Sylhet, Bangladesh. It is located in Gowainghat Upazila of Sylhet District and situated at the border between Bangladesh and the Indian state of Meghalaya, overshadowed by subtropical mountains and rainforests. This place is famous for its collection of stones. Attractions also include tea gardens, hills and the colourful Khashi tribe

- **Lawachara National Park** is a major national park and nature reserve in Bangladesh. This is a protected forest area in Sylhet and is home to many endangered species which are becoming extinct The park is located at Kamalganj Upazila, Maulvi Bazar District in the northeastern region of the country.





Commander in Chief of Bangladesh Forces

Madhabkunda Waterfall is one of the highest waterfalls situated in Barlekha Upazila of Moulvibazar District in Bangladesh, and a prominent tourist spot. The surrounding forest, streams, and ecological park draw numerous visitors for picnics and day trips. The area is also of religious significance to Hindus, featuring a nearby temple where annual rituals and fairs are held.



Tanguar haor located in the Dharmapasha and Tahirpur upazilas of Sunamganj District in Bangladesh, is a unique wetland ecosystem of national importance and has come into international focus. The haor is an ideal place for the migratory birds. Every winter about 200 types of migratory birds come to this haor and make their temporary habitat here. The haor is an important source of fisheries. More than 140 species of fresh water fishes are available here.



Bichnakandi also known as Bisnakandi, is a village in Rustompur Union, Gowainghat Upazila of Bangladesh's Sylhet District. In recent years, there has been an influx of tourists to its river. Breathtaking beauty consisting of gardens, hills, waterfalls, small rocks under a fresh clean sky.

Bichnakandi is a quarry spot that is used to collect rocks from the riverbed. It is the place where many layers of the Khasi mountains from both sides meet at one point. Fountains from the Khasi Hills make a lake that is connected to the Piyain River. The rocks are also natural and come down with water streams from the mountains. It is one of the most visited tourist spots in Bangladesh. This place is alongside the Bangladesh-India border and has two tectonic plates on the verge of colliding.





Ratargul Swamp Forest is the only freshwater swamp forest and wildlife sanctuary in Bangladesh. The location of this water forest is the Khadimnagar union of Sadar Upazila of Sylhet district and Fatehpur union of bordering Upazila Gowainghat. It is known as Sundarban of Sylhet.

It is a unique ecosystem with a variety of flora and fauna and offers breathtaking views of the surrounding hills. The forest covers an area of 3,325.61 acres, of which 504 acres were declared a wildlife sanctuary in 1983.

There are only 22 freshwater wetlands in the world. There are two in the Indian subcontinent. One in Sri Lanka, the other in Bangladesh. In the local language of Sylhet, murta or patigacha is known as 'Ratagacha'. The name of this forest is Ratargul after the name of that idol or Ratagachera.This beautiful forest is comparable to the only Amazon. Like the Amazon, the trees here stay under water for 4 to 7 months a year.

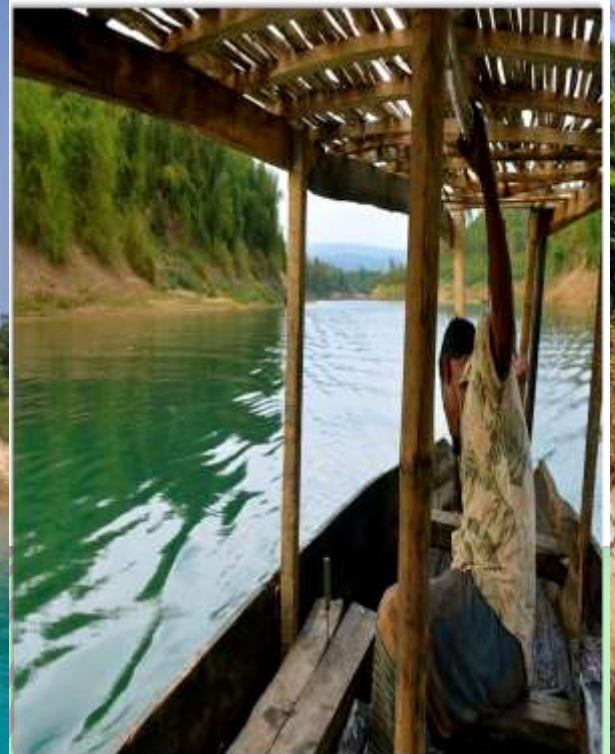






'Lalakhal' is a tourist area and an important place in Jaintapur Upazila of Sylhet near Tamabil road, The Sari Gowain River flows past Lalakhal . The river has numerous bends. The river is not very deep and is one of the sources of sand in Sylhet. The focal point of the feature is the variety of colours of the water, which varies from blue to green to clear at different points. The river is surrounded by hilly forests, tea gardens and various species of trees. The origin of the name 'Lalakhal' is a mysterious one. In Bengali, 'Lalak' means red or redness, while 'Khal' means a canal or river. The name Lalakhal comes from the scarlet hue that the river Shari's water takes on in the winter.

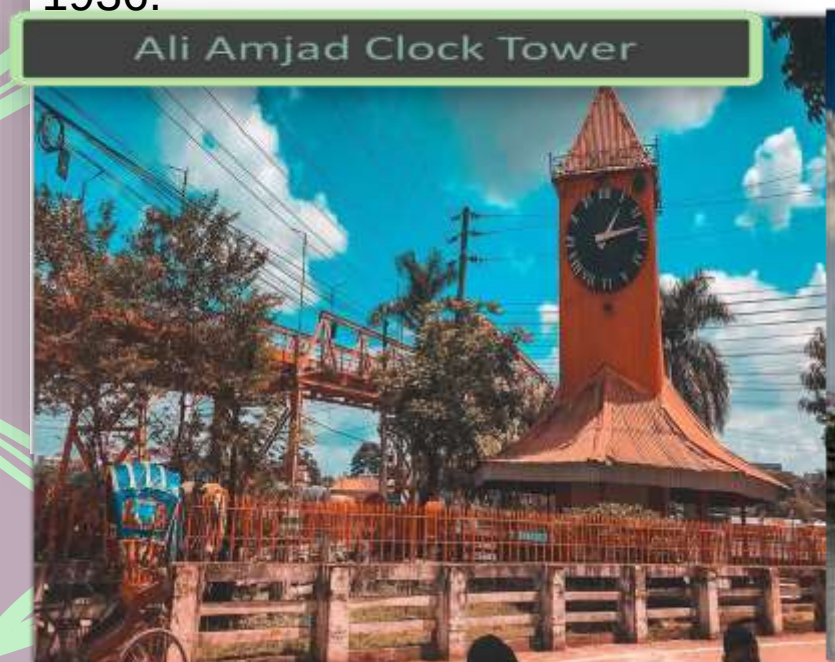


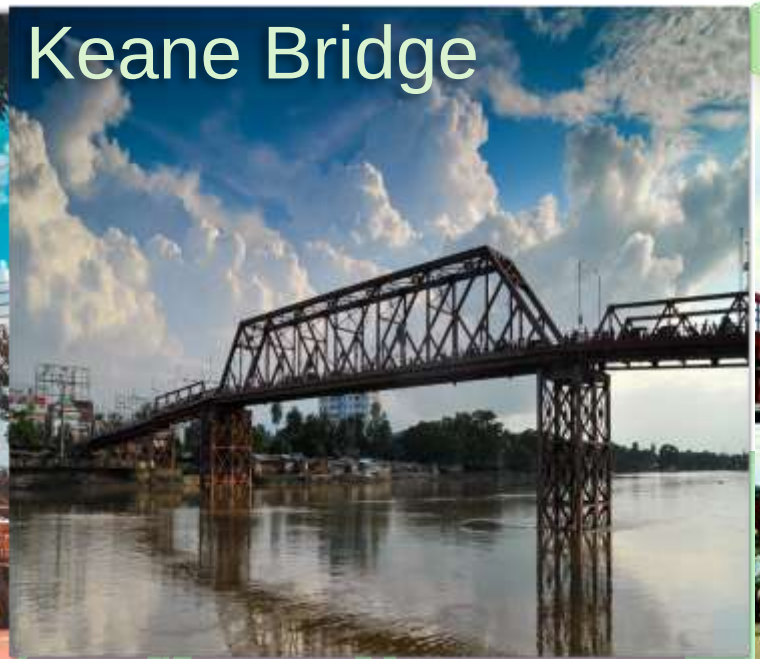


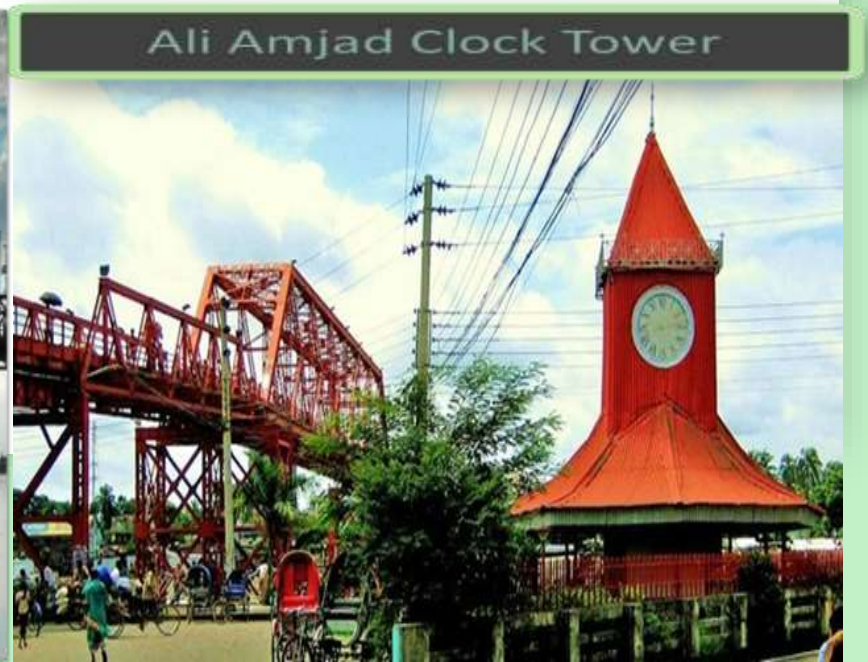


The Ali Amjad Clock is the oldest clock tower of Bangladesh and lies on the north bank of the Surma River in the northeastern city of Sylhet. The tower was founded by Nawab Ali Ahmad Khan of Prithimpassa in 1872 and named after his son, Nawab Ali Amjad Khan. It is a popular tourist attraction adjacent to the Keane Bridge and is often used in the establishing shot of films set in Sylhet.

The Keane Bridge is a notable landmark of Sylhet city, Bangladesh. This bridge is called the gateway to Sylhet city. Keane Bridge was named after Sir Micheal Keane, who was the English governor of Assam from 1932-1937, located on top of Surma River and it is known as the gateway to Sylhet. It was built in the year 1936.









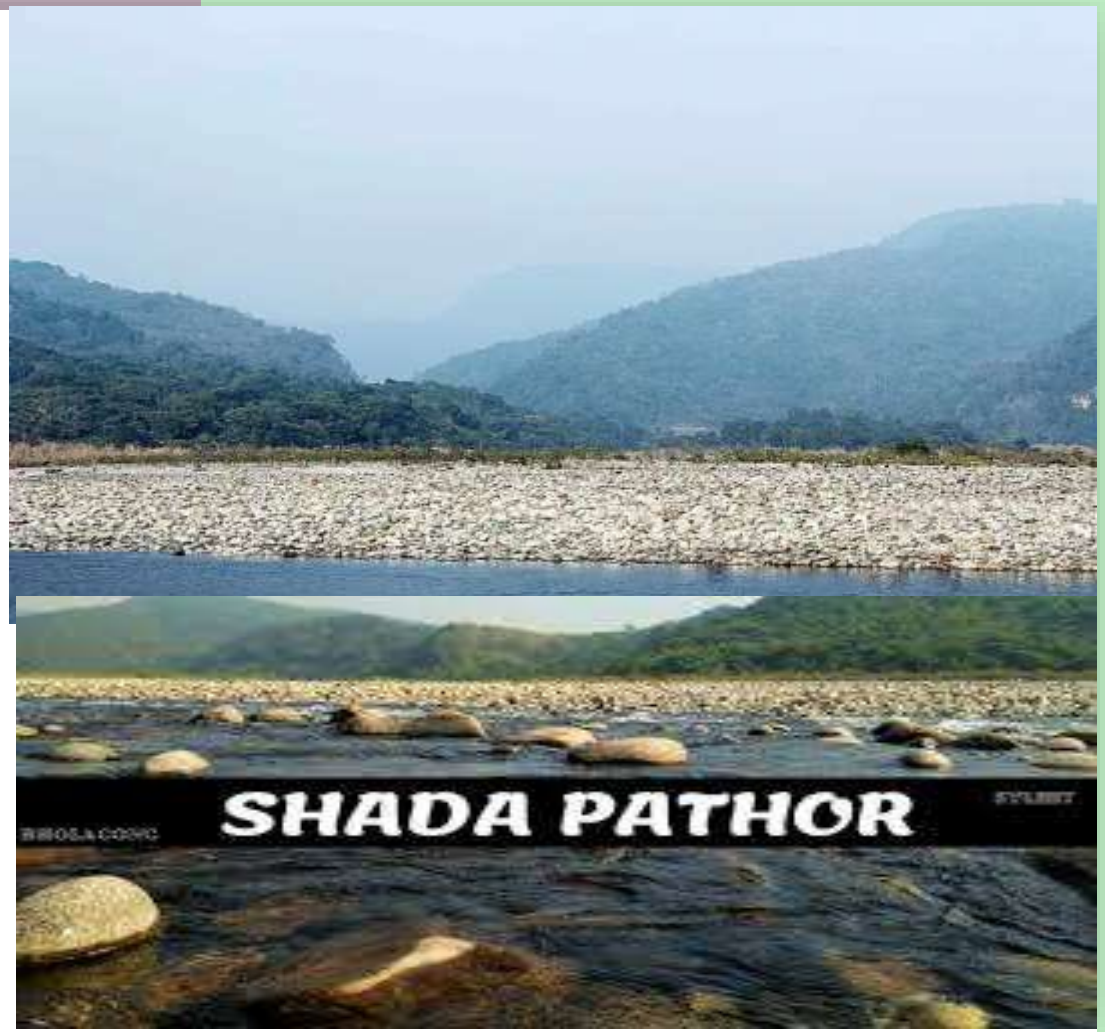




Lakkatura Tea Garden is located near Osmani Airport in Chowkidhenki Upazila of Sylhet District. Lakkatura Tea Garden is the green forest surrounding the northern edge of Sylhet city. It is an official tea garden under the National Tea Board.

Malnichhara Tea Garden is the largest and first established tea garden in Bangladesh and the subcontinent which is located in Sylhet Sadar Upazila. The first tea garden in the subcontinent, Malnichhara, was established in 1849 on an area of 1500 acres by Mr. Hudson. Although the tea garden is currently under private supervision, it is well-known as a place of choice for tourists to have a good time.

Shada Pathor: With strikingly similar views to famed hill station Jaflong, Bholaganj ShadaPathor, located in the Companiganj Upazila and near East Khasi Hills district of Meghalaya, India, is famous for beautiful stones, crystal clear water and green mountains. In this “heaven of white stones,” visitors can enjoy swimming, floating or simply soaking their feet in the beautiful cool water.



HAORS OF SYLHET

Notable Haors:

- **(a) Hakaluki (Kulaura-Barlekha, Moulvibazar, Golapganj-Fenchuganj, Sylhet)**
- **(b) Hail Haor (Srimangal, Moulvibazar)**
- **(c) Tanguar Haor (Tahirpur-Dharmapasha, Sunamganj)**
- **(d) Shanir Haor (Tahirpur, Sunamganj)**
- **(e) Viewing Haor/ 'Dekhar Haor' (South Sunamganj, Sadar, Sunamganj)**
- **(f) Ghungiyazuri, Makar Haor (Habiganj Sadar, Bahubal, Lakhai, Nabiganj and Baniachong, Habiganj).**

Jainteshwari Bari is an archaeological site located in Sylhet, Bangladesh .



Jaintiaswari Bari

The Irrawaddy Inn is an archaeological site located in Sylhet , Bangladesh . It was named after Princess Irrawaddy of the Jaintia Kingdom.

This site is located 30 kilometres northeast of Sylhet city in a place called Sarighat in Jaintapur. This structure can be seen on the way to the tourist attraction Lalakhal.



Munipuri Kings Palace



Munipuri Rajbari (Munipuri Kings palace) which is situated in Sylhet at Mirjajangal, is one of the symbol of ancient architecture. This is also the symbol and part of the culture of this locality. Though it has lost a little it's Intrinsicity lack of proper care but its beauty has not ended yet.

It was built in 19th century by three brother Churging sing, Marjit Sing and Gombir Sing.

Hassan Raja Museum



The Hason Raja Museum, located in Zinda Bazar, Sunamganj, is a Folk museum established in 2006

dedicated to the life and works of the famous Bengali poet and mystic, Hason Raja. This museum is a treasure trove of artifacts, manuscripts, and memorabilia related to the legendary figure.

Culture of Sylhet

- Sylhet's culture is a rich blend of historical influences and ethnic diversity. Shaped by interactions with Arab, Persian, Central Asian, and British civilizations.
- The region's deep spiritual heritage, influenced by Sufi saint Shah Jalal’s arrival in 1303, coexists with strong Hindu and indigenous traditions, fostering religious harmony. The British-era tea gardens further enriched its multicultural fabric. Sylheti people, both at home and in diaspora communities, take pride in their distinct identity. Their music, folklore, and cuisine reflect this unique heritage, making Sylhet a vibrant cultural hub in Bangladesh.

FESTIVALS OF SYLHET

- Hason Festival in Sunamganj
- Manipuri raash festival
- Shah Jalal (R)’s death anniversary and wood-cutting festival
- Birth anniversary celebration of Sri Chaitainya
- Muharram festival at Prithimpasha









SYLHETI CUISINE AND FOOD

- Rice
  - Akhni, Biroin Bhat, Kisuri.
- Meat
  - Beef Shatkora, Chicken tikka masala, Duck Bamboo Curry (popularly known as Sylheti Ash Bash).
- Fish
  - Shutki Shira, Thoikor Tenga.
- Delicacy and savory
  - Bakarkhani, Biscuits, Handesh, Sunga Pitha,Tusha Shinni, Seven Color Tea.









FOOD OF SYLHET



AKHNI

Akhni is made by polao rice and beef or mutton or chicken. It is soft and served hot.

BEEF SHATKORA

Shatkora is a unique citrus fruit of
Sylhet. Shatkora gives a rich, tangy flavor that is complemented with spices.





7 LAYER TEA

Romesh Ram Gour invented the seven-layer tea after discovering that different tea leaves have different densities.

TRIBES OF SYLHET

- The main ethnic groups in the plain lands of Sylhet are Khasi, Manipuri, Garo, Patro, Bishnupriya and Tripura, although ECDOâ€™s non-formal research has indicated that there are approximately 30 different indigenous communities living in Sylhet region. Among these groups, the Manipuri and the Khasi are the largest in population. Each group has distinct linguistic and cultural practices.

MONIPURI

Manipuri, an ethnic community in Bangladesh. Their original home is Manipur, once a sovereign state and now the northeastern zonal state of India. Manipuris migrated to the Bangladesh area and settled here at different times due to wars, conflicts and other reasons.

A significant number of Monipuri indigenous people live in both Sylhet city and Moulvibazaar district in the Greater Sylhet region. Their main religious festival is Sri Sri Moharaashleela, popularly known as the raash festival.

Munipuri community has reputation for their tradition and culture. All most every Munipuri family has a handloom. It is a part of their culture to make own cloth. Besides their traditional dress “Khami” there are lots of hand made things such as Sari, shawl, bag, bed sheets etc. which people can buy.



TRIBES OF SYLHET

- The Khasi people who reside in the hilly areas of Sylhet, Bangladesh, are of the War sub-tribe.
- The Khasi are an indigenous or tribal people, the majority of whom live in the State of Meghalaya in North East India, with small populations in neighbouring Assam, and in parts of Bangladesh. They call themselves Ki Hynñiew trep, which means "the seven huts" in the Khasi language.
- Their language Khasi is the northernmost Austroasiatic language. A substantial minority of the Khasi people follow their tribal religion, called variously Ka Niam Khasi and Ka Niam Tre in the. Other religions practised include Presbyterian, Anglican, Unitarian, Roman Catholic, and very few are Muslims. The main crops produced by the Khasi people living in the War areas, including Bangladesh, are betel leaf, areca nut, and oranges. The War-Khasi people designed and built the living root bridges of the Cherrapunjee region. The Khasis are a matrilineal society.



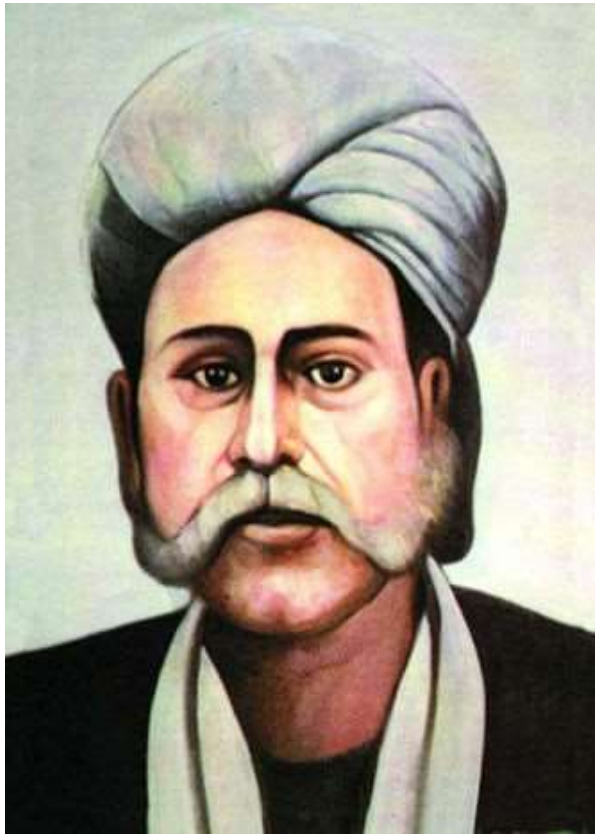
FESTIVALS OF SYLHET

- Jaintia, an ethnic group living in Sylhet region and also known as Synteng, have a very rich tradition and political history. Once they lived in the northern area of Sylhet.
- But after the Partition of Bengal in 1947, majority of them migrated to the Jaintia Hills in Assam where most of them are now settled. A small section of them are now living in Jaintapur Upazila in Sylhet.
- The Jaintias in Bangladesh constitute an ethic group numbering about twenty thousand.
- According to the Anthropologists, Jaintia is one of the ancient original groups who migrated to the North Eastern region of the sub-continent and settled down there. There is a view holding that the Jaintia is a branch of the Khasi community.



Hason Raja

Dewan Hason Raja Chowdhury, or simply known as Hason Raja was born on 21 December 1854 in Lakshmansree, now Sunamganj to a Bengali Muslim zamindar family. He was a Bengali mystic poet and songwriter from Sylhet, Bengal Presidency (now Bangladesh). His unique style of music made him one of the most prominent figures in Bengali folk culture.



His father was Dewan Ali Raja, the grandson of Birendraram Singhdev .Hason Raja's mother was Hurmat Jahan Bibi. Hason Raja spent most of his childhood in Lakshmansree with his mother as his father married widow of his first cousin late Amir Baksh Chowdhury who was living at Lahshmansree (Sunamganj) the most north-eastern part of now Bangladesh. His father started on and off living in Lakshmanshree of Sunamganj, 33 miles away from Rampasha, for at least three or four months of the year. Ali supervised and managed his wife's properties at Lakshmansree. That is why Lakshmansree was his birthplace of the poet.

Raja's songs are collected in books Hason Udas and Shaukhin Bahar It was reported by Washington Bangla Radio in May 2013, that an epic Bengali feature film Hason Raja is under production, based on the life and music of Raja played by Mithun Chakraborty, directed by Ruhul Amin, and produced by Galaxy Films between UK, India and Bangladesh. A volume called Hason Raja Samagra was also published. It contained 500 poems and songs.

Shah Abdul Karim

- Shah Abdul Karim was born on 15 February 1916 in Derai Thana, in Sylhet. He first learnt music from Baul Shah Ibrahim Mastan Baksh. In 1957, Karim had started living in Ujan Dhol, a village near his home, with his wife, Sarala Bibi.

- He was a Bangladeshi Baul musician. Dubbed "Baul Samrat", he was awarded the Ekushey Padak in 2001 by the Government of Bangladesh. Some of his notable songs include Keno Piriti Baraila Re Bondhu, Murshid Dhono He Kemone Chinibo Tomare, Nao Banailo Banailo Re Kon Mestori, Ashi Bole Gelo Bondhu and Mon Mojale Ore Bawla Gaan. He referred to his compositions as Baul Gaan.

- Karim wrote and composed over 1600 songs. The Bangla Academy has translated ten of his songs into the English language





Salman Shah

1971-1996
Film Actor

Shahriar Chowdhury Emon was a Bangladeshi film and television actor.



Noorjahan Kakon Bibi Bir Protik was a Bangladeshi freedom fighter of the Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971. She was arrested and brutally tortured by the Pakistan army. She is one of two female freedom fighters honored with the Bir Protik award, the fourth highest honor in Bangladesh, due to her gallant contribution in the liberation war.

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